

ENR 1.9 AIR TRAFFIC FLOW MANAGEMENT (ATFM)

1. General

1.1 Air Traffic Flow Management (ATFM) in the Philippines is a service provided by the Air Traffic Service of the Civil Aviation Authority of the Philippines. As a Flow Management Unit (FMU), it is responsible for assisting traffic management by ensuring an optimum flow of air traffic to or through areas during times when demand exceeds, or is expected to exceed available capacity of the Air Traffic Control (ATC) system. It embraces any activity concerned with the organization and handling of the flow or air traffic so that the totality of the traffic handled at any given point or in any given area is compatible with the ATC capacity, while ensuring the safe, orderly and expeditious flight of individual aircraft. It supports ATC in meeting its main objectives of preventing collisions between aircraft, expediting and maintaining an orderly flow of air traffic and maximum utilization of available airspace and airport capacity.

1.2 Air Traffic Flow Management Unit (ATFMU) Structure

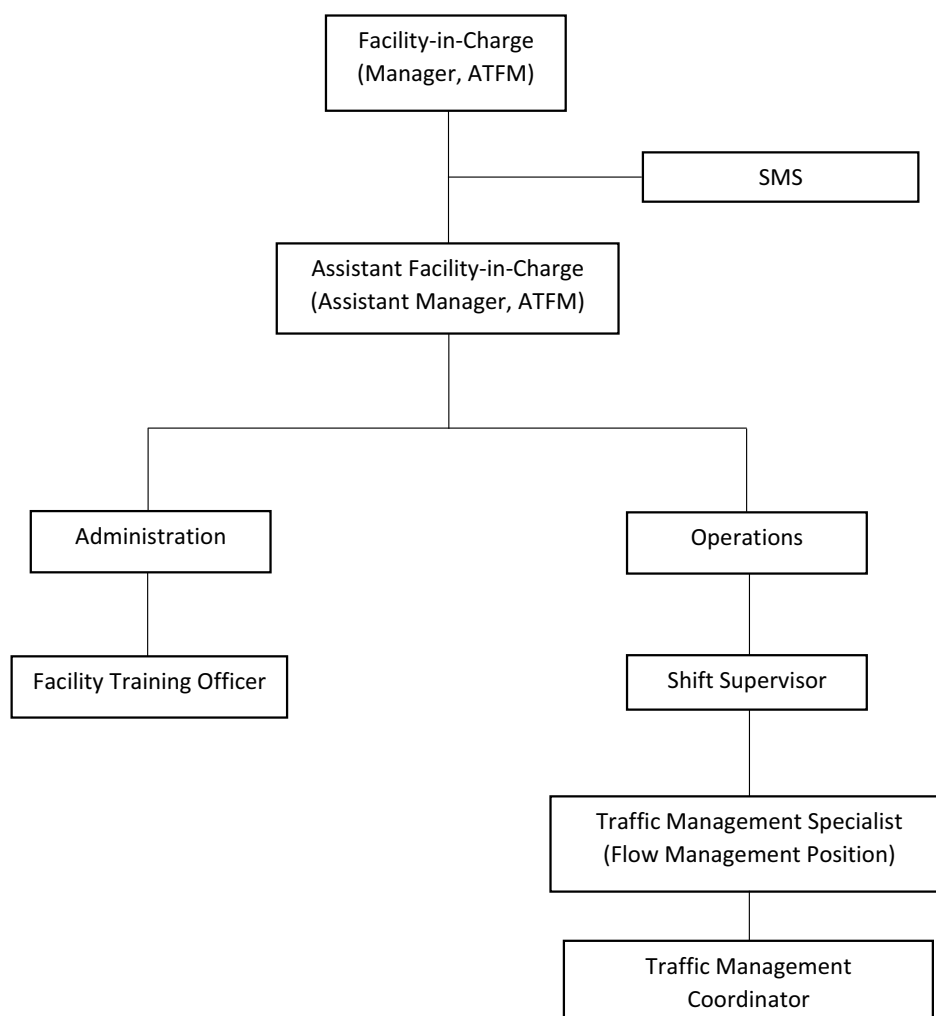


Figure 1: Manila ATFMU Organizational Chart

1.3 Service Area

1.3.1 Manila ATFMU primarily provides Airport ATFM for Ninoy Aquino International Airport (NAIA).

1.3.2 ATFM does not preclude the inclusion of other constrained airports or airspaces needing demand-capacity balancing within the Manila FIR.

- 1.4 Service Provided
 - 1.4.1 As Level 2 Node in the Distributed ATFM Multi-Nodal Network, Manila ATFMU receives and complies with Calculated Take-off Time (CTOT) issued by Level 3 Nodes.
 - 1.4.2 Manila ATFMU provides demand and capacity balancing in NAIA and other constrained airports for all domestic airline flights. General Aviation IFR flights and other civilian flight departing VFR whose final portion of flight to Manila will be conducted under IFR.
- 1.5 Location of Unit

Manila Air Traffic Flow Management Unit
2nd Floor Airways Facilities Complex
Civil Aviation Authority of the Philippines
MIA Road, Pasay City
Philippines 1300
Phone: (632) 7944-2239, (632) 7944-2101
Email: atfm@caap.gov.ph
AFS: RPHIZDZX, RPLLATFM
HR of OPS: 2300 - 1300
- 2. **Types of flow messages and descriptions of the formats**
 - 2.1 The notification messages are disseminated through ATFM Daily Plan (ADP). Any revision or cancellation in the ADP is sent via AMHS/AFTN and email. An ADP should include the following information:
 - a. Aerodrome Identification
 - b. Airport Arrival Rate/Airport Acceptance Rate (AAR)
 - c. Description of constraints
 - d. Time frame
 - e. Proposed ATFM measures; and
 - f. Remarks/other relevant information
- 3. **Procedures applicable for domestic departing flights into constrained airport where ATFM measures are applied:**
 - 3.1 Service responsible for provision of information on applied ATFM measures through Collaborative Decision Making (CDM) by rigorously coordinating with ATCs and Aircraft Operators on a continuous basis.
 - 3.1.1 ATFM measures commonly applied by Manila ATFMU are the following:
 - 3.1.1.1 Ground Delay Program (GDP) imposes delay on the ground to avoid excessive airborne holding or re-routings and flight diversions. GDP period is set depending on the traffic volume expected based on the updated data. When GDP is in effect, CTOT must be secured from Tower/FSS of their departure aerodrome or in the absence of Tower/FSS by directly securing from Manila ATFMU. Compliance window is within -5/+10 minutes of the CTOT. Non-compliant flight shall be the last in priority (sequence) for landing at NAIA. When excessive holding is anticipated, non-compliant aircraft may be advised to proceed to its alternate aerodrome.
 - 3.1.1.1.1 Type of flights exempted from ATFM measures
 - a. Aircraft on a state of emergency, including those subjected to unlawful interference

- b. Humanitarian or medical flights
 - c. State aircraft with Head of State on board
 - d. Search and rescue missions
 - e. Flights required by the State Authorities (Check Flights)
 - f. Military Flights
 - g. Other flights approved by Air Traffic Service
- 3.1.1.1.2 Slot Swapping is applicable to flights departing at the same aerodrome with pilots' concurrence.
- 3.1.1.2 Ground Stop is instituted when adverse conditions or major facility outages cause demand to exceed capacity resulting to a gridlock. This is the most restrictive method of traffic management hence alternative initiatives should be explored and implemented if appropriate.
- 3.2 Flight Planning Requirement
- 3.2.1 A flight plan shall be submitted at least (60) sixty minutes prior to departure.
- 3.2.2 In the event of a delay of thirty (30) minutes for a controlled flight or one (1) hour for an uncontrolled flight in excess of the estimated departure time for which a flight plan has been submitted, the flight plan shall be amended or a new flight plan submitted and the old flight plan cancelled, whichever is applicable.
- 3.3 Slot Allocation
- 3.3.1 For Ninoy Aquino International Airport (NAIA)
 - a. Slots for commercial scheduled flights are requested and allocated during a slot conference attended by the independent slot coordinator and the airlines for summer and winter schedule.
 - b. Slots for general aviation flights are requested to and approved by ATS under the Authority of the Director General of CAA of the Philippines, implementing the Joint Memorandum Circular 2016-02. Approved slots must be indicated in item number 18 at the flight plan.
- 3.3.2 For other constrained airport pre-tactical slot assignment is issued by Manila ATFMU.
- 4. Responsibility of Aircraft Operators/Pilot-in-Command**
 - a. Update Estimated Off Block Time (EOBT) as accurately as possible
 - b. Ensure the aircraft to arrange pushback, taxi and be ready for take-off within the issued CTOT.
 - c. When it has become apparent that the CTOT cannot be complied due to airline operational requirement, Aircraft Operator/Pilot-in-command must advise their new EOBT.

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